

5. Student Representation

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Guild of Students



As a student at the University, you are automatically a member of the Guild of Students and have full access to the wide range of services and facilities we offer.

Your Guild is here to:

Represent you

- The Guild represents you and over 38,000 students to the University, and ensures you're involved in the big conversations.

Support you

- Whenever you need it, the Guild **Advice service**  is here to provide academic, housing, money wellbeing or international support.

Entertain you

- Whether that's helping you to make friends and learn new skills by joining one of their 350+ student groups or organising some fantastic activities for you to enjoy.

Help you make change

- You can create positive change by becoming a **Student Rep**  and relaying your fellow students' academic feedback to the Guild and the University, submitting ideas for change, or applying to **become a Guild Officer**  to make a real difference for students on campus.

The Guild is run by students, for students, and is led by a team of elected Officers who ensure your voice is heard and that you have the best student experience. You can contact the **Officer team**  if you have questions about university life or want to change things on campus.

The Guild is also home to **over 350 student groups** , so whether you're interested in singing, sports, politics or food - you're sure to find the perfect group for you. You can join a student group at any point throughout the year, and each group will host its own calendar of events and activities. Plus, if you have an idea for a new student group **you can even start your own** , giving you the chance to meet like-minded students through a shared interest.

Find out more about all of the above on the **Guild of Students website** .

Student Representation System

The Student Representation System (SRS) is a partnership between the University of Birmingham and the Guild of Students. The aim of the SRS is to ensure that every student and Postgraduate Researcher at the University of Birmingham is effectively represented to the University and the Guild by a fellow student or Postgraduate Researcher and are partners in their education to allow a more active involvement in, and ownership of, their learning. This representation is provided at programme-level, Department-level, or School-level, as well as College and University level, and provides a voice at relevant education, programme approval, and quality assurance committees. You can see more information on the SRS on the **Student Representation Intranet page** .

Student Reps are current University of Birmingham students and researchers, who work to collect and act on your feedback and to represent your academic interests to the University. At the University of Birmingham, over 1,000 Student Reps at Undergraduate, Postgraduate Taught and Postgraduate Research level, work with the Guild and University to represent students' academic interests and to make real changes to teaching and learning on campus. Becoming a Rep is a great opportunity for students to contribute to the development of the academic experience and gain key skills which will be useful in a wide range of careers. If you would like to talk to a Rep or you are interested in getting involved, more information can be found on the **Student Reps page**  on the Guild of Students website.

Staff Student Forum

Formal Student, Postgraduate Researcher and staff interactions occur through Staff Student Forums (SSFs). SSFs can be at programme-level, Department-level, or School-level and represent specific or combined levels of study. SSFs discuss topics related to education and other topics arising from the students and / or Postgraduate Researchers being represented. This may include the content and quality of programmes and modules, the development of the curriculum and its delivery, assessment methods, learning and teaching methods and the provision of research skills support for Postgraduates, alongside feedback on assessed work, student support and / or supervision, learning resources, facilities, or study spaces. Common themes arising from SSFs are, when necessary, disseminated to College committees, and the University-level **Student Representation System Advisory Group** .

Elections for student representatives are operated by the Guild of Students at the start of every academic year.

SSF Agendas and Minutes: <https://www.cs.bham.ac.uk/internal/local/committees/staffstudent>

National Student Survey



The National Student Survey (NSS) provides all final year students with the opportunity to reflect on their university experience. The results are a useful source of information for all universities, including the University of Birmingham. The School of Computer Science will contact all finalists to let them know when the survey is released. We value all student feedback and work hard to support the survey. That said, we hope that you won't wait until final year to get in touch!

Information on feedback sessions with the Head of Education, the Director of Student Experience or your UG Year Lead are available [here](#).

Module Feedback



By being an active learner, asking questions, and seeking advice you give module organisers useful feedback on teaching. The School has an established system for formal feedback on all modules. You will regularly be asked to complete a module questionnaire. We collate and analyse this information to see ensure that modules are being delivered effectively.

